PAST PERFECT (had+past participle)

An action completed before a past action
When we arrived, the class had already begun.





In the Third Conditional of "if"
If it had rained, I would have bought an umbrella.

Reported speech
My student said that he hadn't done his homework.

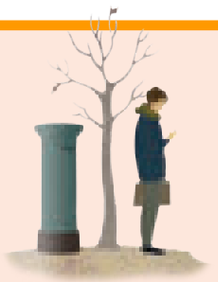




A period of time before an event in the past
We had owned our house for twenty years before we sold it

PAST PERFECT CONTINUOUS
(had+been+verb+ing)

Continued action in the past, before an action in the past



He had been waiting for an hour when she finally arrived.

Cause of something in the past

He went on a diet because he had been eating too much.



"If"- impossible condition



If I had been paying attention, I wouldn't have got into an accident.

Reported speech

She said that John had been helping her study for months.



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